green vehicles, bicycles etc.), which is higher than the LEED maximum baseline of 70%. This results in approx. 4,50,000 less CO2 emissions, which is equivalent to planting 21,600 trees per year.

Sustainable Sites

The Sustainable Sites credit undertakes to preserve and improve ecological integrity while facilitating high-performance building operations. By planting native plants, conducting soil testing, using organic fertilizer and reducing turf areas, the Group has managed to improve the site's hydrology, vegetation and soil quality. The Group has allocated 26% area to native vegetation that demands fewer fertilizers, pesticides, and water and at the same time negates other adverse environmental impacts. The building remains equipped with 9 rainwater harvesting pits, and open grid pavers to reduce the stormwater run-off from the site and enhance water quantity. In addition to these are the DSHQ's organic waste composters, providing for a closed-loop system of zero organic waste.

Water Efficiency

Water Efficiency credit measures reduction in indoor and outdoor water consumption. Through its low flow fixtures, water aerators, dual flush closets and water-efficient urinals, the Group has reduced indoor water usage by 32%. With the landscaping



being curated to limit the use of potable water for irrigation, outdoor water usage has also been significantly reduced. A further 53% reduction in water consumption has been brought about by the implementation of other measures such as planting of native and drought-tolerant species, use of drip irrigation for trees, a micro-spray system for turf areas and use of STP (Sewage Treatment Plant) and ETP (Effluent Treatment Plant) treated water for irrigation. Another notable measure is the installation of a secondary RO Plant to the main RO reject line, which is equipped with a high TDS sea membrane that blends the reject into an irrigation water system resulting in Zero discharge.

Energy and Atmosphere

This section deals with energy management, and the reduction of environmental and economic harm pertaining to excessive energy use. In their endeavors to reduce greenhouse gas emissions and achieve a higher level of operating energy performance, reduce ozone depletion while minimizing direct contribution to climate change, the headquarters have been designed in such a way that over 50% of the regularly occupied area has daylight viewing, which automatically brings down artificial lighting consumption. The actual energy consumption is 59% better than LEED national median and the Group's EPA (Environmental Protection Agency) energy star score is 95.



Material and Resources

All IT equipment at the DS Group has the US EPA ENERGY STAR Certification. These products are energy efficient and automatically get into a low-power mode when not in use, thereby cutting down on the utility and operating costs. Of the new wooden items purchased by the organization, including plywood and board, more than 80% are Forest Stewardship Council (FSC) certified against the LEED baseline of 75%.

Indoor Environment Quality

With its thrust on Indoor Environmental Quality, the DSHQ building implements a commercial purification system to treat nearly 4.0 lakh CFM of air to control PM 2.5 and above particulate matter.

With the well-being of the employees at the workplace being of utmost concern, low VOC paint material and Green Shield cleaning chemicals are used to enhance the indoor air quality for the well-being of the employees.

Innovation in Design Process & Regional Priority

With its commitment to the reduction of its carbon footprint, in this category, the Group has a 100% credit rating. The building is on its way to acquiring carbon neutral status by the end of 2022. The Group has at its disposal solar open access with a combined capacity of 5 MW. This capacity is further enhanced to 8 MW. An EPR (extended producer responsibility agreement) has been signed to cater to plastic waste collection. The Group has accorded great importance to its mission of reducing water and paper consumption.

The Group lays great emphasis on the strategic integration of sustainability into the organizational Systems and Processes for monitoring and understanding long-term trends and the effect of resource use. As a sustainable organization, DS Group prides itself on its holistic approach to doing business, prioritizing what is referred to as the triple bottom line, the planet, people and profit.